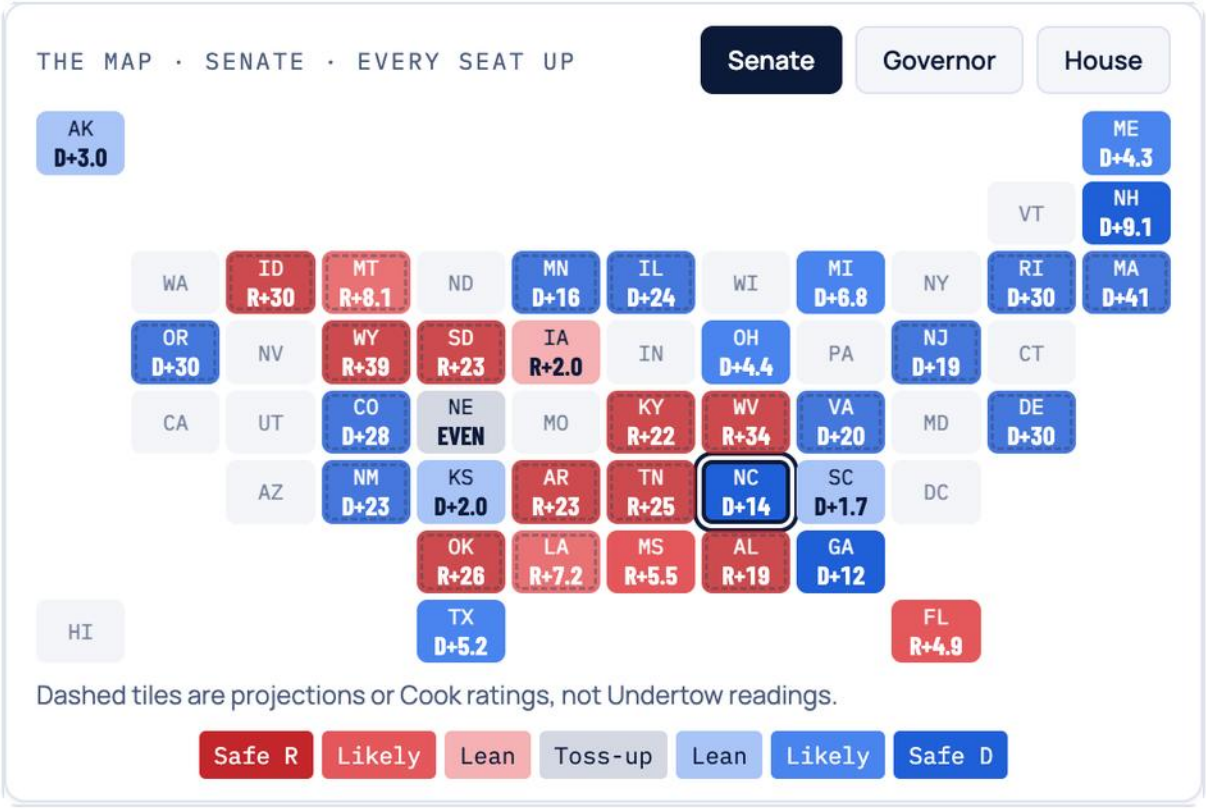
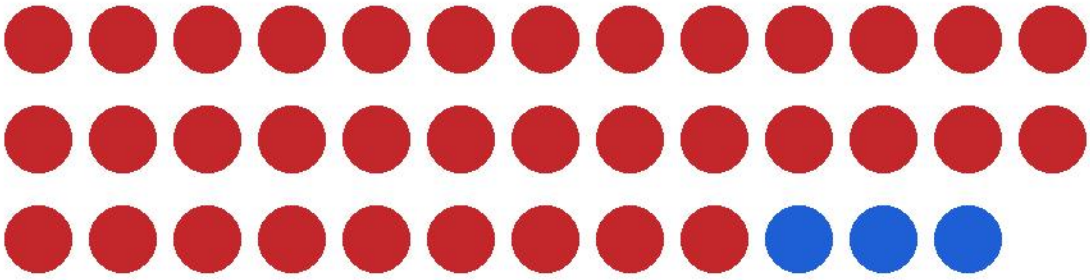
I bet the polls are still missing Democrats. This week I put odds on it.



By Max Sheahan · midtermundertow.com

Counted one race at a time, Democrats looked 99% to control the Senate.

That math assumes every race misses on its own. Polls do not miss that way. When they are off, they are off in the same direction almost everywhere.



35 of 38 races: polls ran too Democratic

3 of 38: polls ran too Republican

2020 Senate and governor races, 538 polling archive

By Max Sheahan · midtermundertow.com

Drawn together, it is 91%.

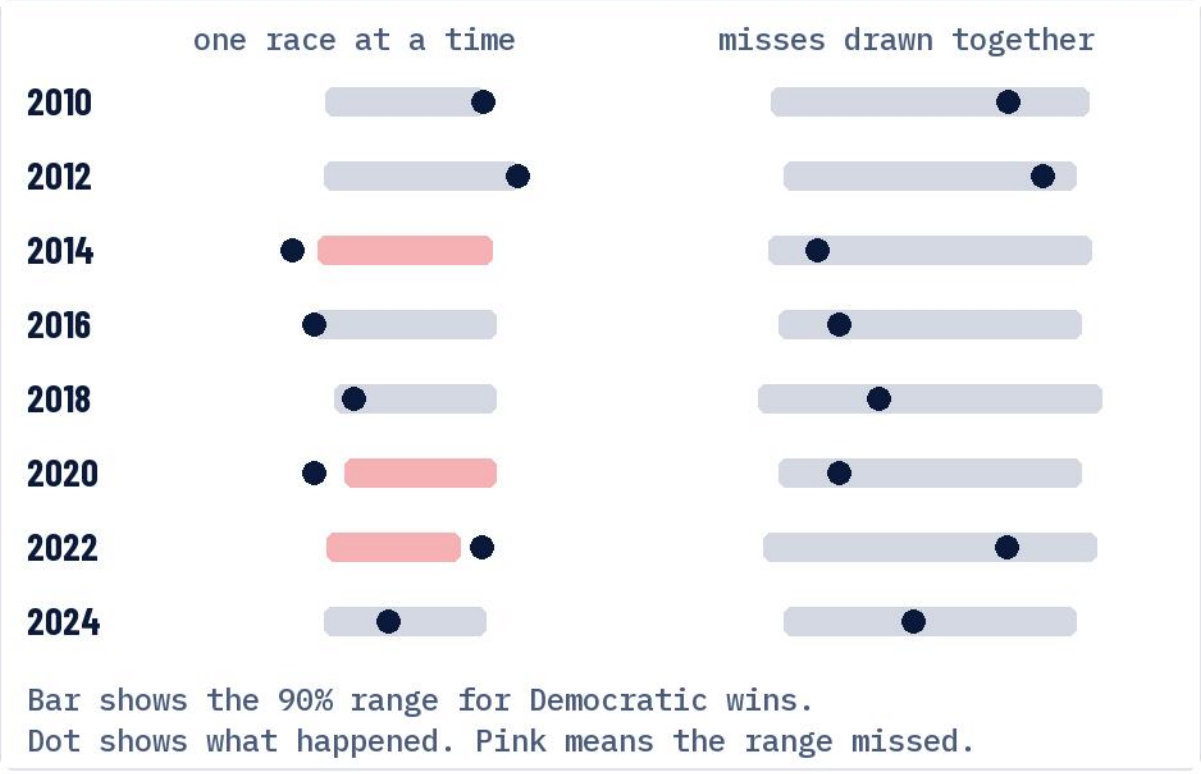
20,000 simulated elections. Each one draws a national miss, a regional miss, a state miss and each race's own, then counts the seats.



House, same method, 99%.

I replayed every polled Senate and governor race from 2010 to 2024.

Counting races one at a time missed the real seat count in 3 of 8 years. Drawing the misses together missed none.



Bar shows the 90% range for Democratic wins.
Dot shows what happened. Pink means the range missed.

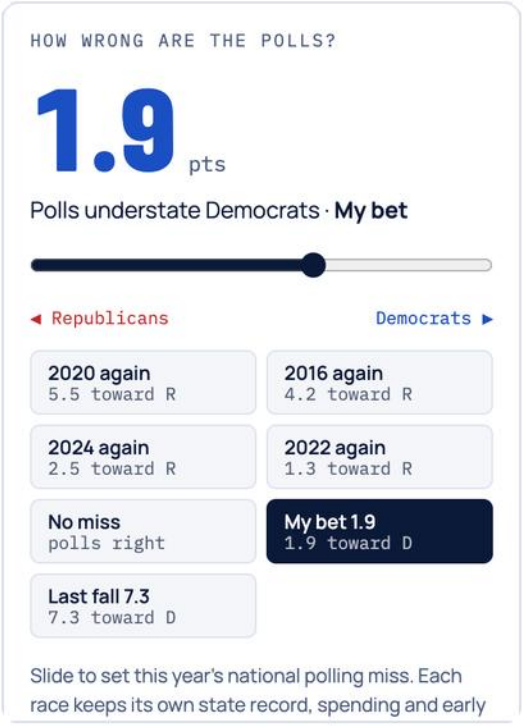
By Max Sheahan · midtermundertow.com

I did not trust my Iowa number.

Checking it found a real bug in how I read early voting, so I fixed it for every state at once. The rest held. Trump won Iowa by 13, the national swing is about 11, and that puts Iowa right around R +2, where I have it.



It freezes Monday, November 2, and gets graded against the results.



midtermundertow.com

By Max Sheahan · midtermundertow.com